to respond to each other's patrols more quickly and in larger numbers as well.

This last interpretation is favoured by M. Taylor Fravel, professor of political science at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), an expert on China's territorial quarrels including with India. In an analysis of China's view of the border incursions and confrontations over the past twenty years, he argues that a perceptible increase occurred after 2010 and that 'the general increase in Chinese activity' is due to 'China . . . responding to several changes along the border'. He identifies three changes, from Beijing's perspective: 'substantial improvement of India's border infrastructure'; 'modification of the Indian military's force structure directed at China'; and 'an increase in the frequency of Indian patrols along the LAC'. He attributes the confrontation in Daulat Beg Oldie in Depsang in April 2013 and in Chumar in September 2014 to patrolling and the building or modernization of existing infrastructure in the area.[120]

To his list, we could add the conflict in Burtse in September 2015, which the Indian media seems to have forgotten but which also occurred when the two militaries objected to the other's infrastructure activities in Ladakh. These three incidents in Ladakh were followed by a seventy-three-day stand-off in Doklam (Donglang) near the trijunction of India, China, and Bhutan in 2017. The stand-off occurred in Bhutanese territory when the Indian Army, with Bhutan's knowledge, crossed over to Doklam to confront a Chinese road-building crew that was extending an old road. Here again, it was border infrastructure activity that led to a confrontation.

At any rate, with growing intrusions after 2008, it was necessary for Delhi and Beijing to sit down to put in place further understandings on peace and stability along the LAC. In 2012, they agreed on a Working Mechanism for Consultations and Coordination on matters related to the border. Mid-level officers in the two foreign ministries were charged with increasing cooperation between the militaries especially at the border, discussing tensions that might arise there, and holding regular consultations once or twice a year. In effect, the two sides felt the need for the two foreign ministries to be involved parallel to the militaries to ensure stability. The